



Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

UEN: 201200696W

LESSON PLAN

For

Creating Stunning Print and Digital Publications with InDesign

TGS Ref No: TGS-2021007827

Conducted by

Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

UEN: 201200696W

Version 12.0

DOCUMENT VERSION CONTROL RECORD

Version Number	Effective Date of Release	Summary of Included Changes	Author
11.0	1 September 2021	Legacy release — 3-topic lesson plan with 14 in-class activities.	Dr Alfred Ang
12.0	19 August 2026	Major revision. Rebuilt against the current InDesign release and the TSC RET-DNI-4004-1.1 ability and knowledge statements. Expanded from 14 to 20 case-study activities built on a single running client brief (Harmony Petals). Added establishing the drawing requirement, effective resolution, the Links panel, compound paths and Pathfinder, object styles, preflight, package and PDF/X export, and reflowable vs fixed-layout EPUB. Schedule re-timed to 9:30 am – 6:30 pm with a 1-hour lunch. Slide references updated to the v12.0 deck.	Dr Alfred Ang

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Course Information.....	4
Target Audience.....	4
Prerequisites.....	4
Learning Outcomes.....	4
Skills Framework Alignment.....	5
Assessment.....	5
Course Schedule.....	5
Day 1 — From Client Brief to Print- and Screen-Ready Publication.....	5
Assessment Session (following the training day).....	6
Activity Reference (aligned to the learning outcomes).....	7
Training Resources.....	9

Course Information

Course Title	Creating Stunning Print and Digital Publications with InDesign
WSQ Course Reference	TGS-2021007827
Training Provider	Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd (UEN 201200696W)
Duration	1 day · 8 instructional hours, plus 90 minutes of assessment
Daily Timing	9:30 am – 6:30 pm (1-hour lunch break; tea breaks counted within training time)
Mode of Delivery	Instructor-led classroom delivery with hands-on Adobe InDesign practice at every learner's workstation
Trainer	Dr Alfred Ang
Skills Framework	Manual and Digital Drawings Production (RET-DNI-4004-1.1)

Target Audience

- Graphic and layout designers moving into publication work
- Marketing and communications executives who produce collateral in-house
- Editorial and publishing professionals
- Branding and content creators preparing print and digital assets
- Career-changers building an Adobe Creative Cloud skill set

Prerequisites

Knowledge & skills	Able to operate a computer confidently. Minimum 3 GCE 'O' Levels including English, or WPL Level 5.
Experience	Minimum 1 year of working experience.
Attitude	Positive learning mindset and willingness to participate in hands-on practice.
Software	Adobe InDesign (2024 or later) installed on a Windows or macOS laptop.
Hardware	Laptop with a mouse; a minimum 1280 x 800 display is recommended.
Files	The course lab files, downloaded from the LMS before the class starts.

Learning Outcomes

On completion of this course, learners will be able to:

- LO1: Establish the drawing layout requirement and create the InDesign document.
- LO2: Utilize InDesign tools for drawings.
- LO3: Refine drawings using InDesign.

Skills Framework Alignment

TSC Title: Manual and Digital Drawings Production · TSC Code: RET-DNI-4004-1.1

Ref	TSC Ability / Knowledge Statement	Covered by
A1	Establish drawing requirements	Topic 1 · Activities 1, 3; Topic 3 · Activity 19
A2	Determine document dimensions, angles, shapes and finished sizes of project requirements	Topic 1 · Activities 1–4
A3	Identify and select appropriate mediums for drawings	Topic 1 · Activity 2; Topic 2 · Activities 7, 10; Topic 3 · Activities 19, 20
A4	Refine drawings to meet project requirements within scope of authority	Topic 2 · Activities 8–12; Topic 3 · Activities 13–20
K1	Types, techniques and processes of manual production drawings	Topic 1 — drawing conventions and manual layout principles
K2	Types of computer-aided drawing equipment, software, techniques and processes	Topic 1 — InDesign as computer-aided layout software and its place in Creative Cloud
K3	Conventional signs and markings for drawings	Topic 2 and Topic 3 — the digital production drawing workflow end to end

Assessment

- Oral Questioning (OQ) — 5 questions, 15 minutes, 1:1 with the assessor, open book. Covers the underpinning knowledge K1–K3.
- Practical Performance (PP) — hands-on InDesign layout tasks, 75 minutes, open book. Covers the abilities A1–A4.
- Format: Open Book — course slides, Learner Guide and approved materials only.
- The assessment is conducted at the end of the training day, after the TRAQOM survey and the Assessment digital attendance have been taken.
- Learners are graded Competent (C) or Not Yet Competent (NYC) on each instrument.
- A minimum of 75% attendance is required to be eligible for assessment and funding.

Course Schedule

Day 1 — From Client Brief to Print- and Screen-Ready Publication

Time	Duration	Topic / Activity [slide reference]
9:30–9:45	15 min	Digital Attendance (AM) · Welcome · Trainer and learner introductions · Ground rules [Slides 2-7]
9:45–10:00	15 min	Course material download from the LMS · Skills Framework alignment (TSC RET-DNI-4004-1.1) · Learning outcomes · Course outline · Assessment briefing [Slides 8-19]
10:00–10:30	30 min	Core concepts: why InDesign · what it is for · which Creative Cloud application owns which job · InDesign vs the alternatives [Slides 20-24]
10:30–11:00	30 min	Topic 1 Get Started on InDesign — key concepts: establishing the drawing and

		layout requirement, page anatomy (trim, bleed, margin, slug), colour mode and resolution [Slides 25-32]
11:00–11:15	15 min	Tea break (counted within training time)
11:15–11:45	30 min	Topic 1 continued — the InDesign interface and workspace, the New Document dialog, the two selection tools, parent pages, automatic page numbering, grids and guides, Adjust Layout [Slides 33-40]
11:45–13:00	75 min	Topic 1 hands-on — Activity 1 Establish the Layout Requirement from a Client Brief; Activity 2 Create the Document and Explore the InDesign Workspace; Activity 3 Build a Parent Page with Automatic Page Numbering; Activity 4 Set Up Grids, Guides and a Modular Column Structure [Slides 41-57]
13:00–14:00	60 min	Lunch Break
14:00–14:10	10 min	Digital Attendance (PM) · Recap of the morning [Slide 58]
14:10–14:45	35 min	Topic 2 Basic InDesign Drawing Techniques — key concepts: frames and content, text and threading, placing graphics and the Links panel, paths and the Pen tool [Slides 59-67]
14:45–15:45	60 min	Topic 2 hands-on part 1 — Activity 5 Create Text Frames and Import Client Copy from Word; Activity 6 Thread Text Across Frames and Resolve Overset Copy; Activity 7 Place Graphics, Manage Links and Control Effective Resolution; Activity 8 Draw Custom Paths with the Pen and Pencil Tools [Slides 75-91]
15:45–16:00	15 min	Tea break (counted within training time)
16:00–16:20	20 min	Topic 2 continued — compound paths and Pathfinder, clipping paths and text wrap, colour and swatches, transparency and effects, transform, align and layers [Slides 68-74]
16:20–17:00	40 min	Topic 2 hands-on part 2 — Activity 9 Combine Shapes with Pathfinder and Wrap Text Around a Clipping Path; Activity 10 Build a Colour System with Swatches, Spot Colours and Gradients; Activity 11 Apply Transparency, Blending Modes and Effects for Print; Activity 12 Transform, Align and Organise Objects with Layers [Slides 92-107]
17:00–17:25	25 min	Topic 3 Refine InDesign Drawings — key concepts: typography and type on a path, the styles cascade, tables, interactivity, preflight, package and export [Slides 109-124]
17:25–18:10	45 min	Topic 3 hands-on — Activity 13 Set Type on a Path for a Curved Masthead; Activity 14 Refine Character and Paragraph Formatting for Readability; Activity 15 Build and Apply a House Style Set; Activity 16 Import Data and Build a Formatted Price Table; Activity 17 Add Hyperlinks, Buttons and QR Codes for an Interactive Document; Activity 18 Animate Objects with Motion Presets and Page Transitions; Activity 19 Preflight, Package and Export a Print-Ready PDF/X; Activity 20 Export for Digital Delivery — Interactive PDF, EPUB and Publish Online [Slides 125-157]
18:10–18:20	10 min	Course summary · what you achieved · continuing your learning · Q&A [Slides 158-167]
18:20–18:30	10 min	Course Feedback and TRAQOM Survey · Digital Attendance (Assessment)

Note: Topic 2's key concepts are taught in two blocks either side of the first practice session, so its slide references intentionally return to an earlier range after the 14:45 activities.

Total instructional time: 480 minutes (8 hours), excluding the 60-minute lunch break.

Assessment Session (following the training day)

Time	Duration	Assessment Instrument
18:30–19:45	75 min	Practical Performance (PP) — hands-on InDesign layout tasks, 75 minutes, open book. Assesses A1, A2, A3, A4.
19:45–20:00	15 min	Oral Questioning (OQ) — five questions, one-to-one with the assessor, 15 minutes, open book. Assesses K1, K2, K3.

Activity Reference (aligned to the learning outcomes)

Topic	Weighting	LO	Activities
Topic 01: Get Started on InDesign	30%	LO1	1, 2, 3, 4
Topic 02: Basic InDesign Drawing Techniques	40%	LO2	5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12
Topic 03: Refine InDesign Drawings	30%	LO3	13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20

#	Activity	Learning outcome and TSC reference
1	Establish the Layout Requirement from a Client Brief	LO1 — Establish drawing and layout requirements from a client brief and translate them into a written InDesign document specification (TSC A1, A2).
2	Create the Document and Explore the InDesign Workspace	LO1 — Create an InDesign document to a stated specification and navigate the workspace, panels and selection tools with confidence (TSC A2, A3).
3	Build a Parent Page with Automatic Page Numbering	LO1 — Manage pages using parent pages, automatic numbering markers and the Adjust Layout feature so a multi-page publication remains maintainable (TSC A2, A4).
4	Set Up Grids, Guides and a Modular Column Structure	LO1 — Determine document dimensions and structure by building a baseline grid, a document grid and a modular guide system that aligns every element on the page (TSC A2, A4).
5	Create Text Frames and Import Client Copy from Word	LO2 — Determine the text areas of a layout and select the appropriate import method to bring supplied client copy into InDesign without corrupting the document's typography (TSC A2, A3).
6	Thread Text Across Frames and Resolve Overset Copy	LO2 — Refine a text layout by threading a story across multiple frames and pages, and diagnose and resolve overset text so no client copy is lost at output (TSC A2, A4).
7	Place Graphics, Manage Links and Control Effective Resolution	LO2 — Identify and select appropriate image mediums and formats for print, place them into frames with correct fitting, and verify effective PPI meets the printer's requirement (TSC A3, A4).
8	Draw Custom Paths with the Pen and Pencil Tools	LO2 — Establish drawing requirements and construct precise vector paths using anchor points, straight segments and Bezier curves to produce artwork to specification (TSC A1, A4).
9	Combine Shapes with Pathfinder and Wrap Text Around a Clipping Path	LO2 — Refine drawings to meet project requirements by combining shapes into compound paths, applying Pathfinder operations and

		wrapping body copy around an irregular image silhouette (TSC A2, A4).
10	Build a Colour System with Swatches, Spot Colours and Gradients	LO2 — Identify and select appropriate colour mediums for the print process, and build a reusable, correctly specified swatch system including spot and process colours and gradients (TSC A1, A3).
11	Apply Transparency, Blending Modes and Effects for Print	LO2 — Refine layout elements using transparency, blending modes and the Effects panel while selecting settings appropriate to the chosen print medium (TSC A3, A4).
12	Transform, Align and Organise Objects with Layers	LO2 — Manage objects by transforming them precisely, aligning and distributing them to the document structure, and organising the file with layers so it can be handed over and maintained (TSC A2, A4).
13	Set Type on a Path for a Curved Masthead	LO3 — Refine a layout by placing and controlling type on a path so display typography follows the artwork geometry accurately (TSC A4).
14	Refine Character and Paragraph Formatting for Readability	LO3 — Refine drawings to meet project requirements by applying professional character and paragraph typography — kerning, tracking, leading, drop caps and nested styles (TSC A3, A4).
15	Build and Apply a House Style Set	LO3 — Refine drawings to project requirements by constructing a reusable paragraph, character and object style set that enforces a consistent house look across a publication (TSC A1, A4).
16	Import Data and Build a Formatted Price Table	LO3 — Refine a publication by importing tabular data, converting it to an InDesign table and formatting it with table and cell styles for repeatable, accurate presentation (TSC A3, A4).
17	Add Hyperlinks, Buttons and QR Codes for an Interactive Document	LO3 — Refine a publication for a digital medium by adding hyperlinks, interactive buttons and generated QR codes that function reliably in the exported file (TSC A3, A4).
18	Animate Objects with Motion Presets and Page Transitions	LO3 — Refine a digital publication by applying animation, motion paths, timing controls and page transitions appropriate to the delivery medium (TSC A3, A4).
19	Preflight, Package and Export a Print-Ready PDF/X	LO3 — Refine and validate a document against print production requirements, then package the job and export a press-ready PDF/X file with correct bleed and marks (TSC A1, A3, A4).
20	Export for Digital Delivery — Interactive PDF, EPUB and Publish Online	LO3 — Identify and select the appropriate digital medium for a publication and export to it correctly,

		choosing between interactive PDF, reflowable EPUB, fixed-layout EPUB and Publish Online (TSC A1, A3, A4).
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Training Resources

- Trainer slide deck (PPTX and PDF) — 167 slides, version v12.0
- Learner Guide (DOCX and PDF) — full step-by-step procedures for all 20 activities
- This Lesson Plan (DOCX and PDF)
- InDesign lab files, distributed through the LMS at <https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com>
- One workstation per learner with Adobe InDesign 2024 or later, signed in to Creative Cloud
- Projector or large display for trainer demonstration; whiteboard for the client-brief discussion